

META MINDS PVT. LTD.

EMPLOYEE EMPLOYMENT, CONFIDENTIALITY, INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & DATA SECURITY AGREEMENT

Document Type: Employment Agreement

Applicable To: Paid Employees of META MINDS PVT. LTD.

Acceptance Method: Electronic Acceptance through HR Portal

1. PARTIES

This Employment Agreement ("Agreement") is between:

META MINDS PVT. LTD., having its registered/official office at:

Address: _____

hereinafter referred to as the **"Company"**;

AND

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Email: _____

Mobile: _____

Designation: _____

Department: _____

Date of Joining: _____

Reporting Manager: _____

hereinafter referred to as the **"Employee"**.

2. APPOINTMENT

2.1 The Company appoints the Employee to the position specified in the employee's appointment details.

2.2 The Employee agrees to perform the duties, responsibilities and functions assigned by the Company from time to time.

2.3 The Employee shall report to the designated manager or any other person authorised by the Company.

2.4 The Employee agrees to perform duties professionally, honestly, diligently and in the best interests of the Company.

3. EMPLOYMENT STATUS

The Employee shall be a paid employee of META MINDS PVT. LTD. subject to the terms of the applicable appointment letter and Company policies.

The Employee's salary, designation, joining date, work location and other employment-specific details shall be recorded separately in the Employee's appointment/employment letter and HR records.

4. SALARY AND COMPENSATION

4.1 The Employee's compensation shall be specified in the appointment letter issued by the Company.

4.2 Salary shall be subject to applicable statutory deductions and requirements.

4.3 The Company may make lawful deductions required by applicable law.

4.4 Any salary revision, increment, bonus, incentive or promotion shall be subject to Company policy, performance and applicable law and shall not be guaranteed unless expressly confirmed in writing.

5. WORKING HOURS

5.1 The Employee shall follow the working hours and attendance requirements communicated by the Company.

5.2 Depending upon the Employee's role, the Company may operate flexible, hybrid, remote or shift-based working arrangements.

5.3 The Employee shall comply with the Company's attendance and leave policies.

5.4 The Employee may be required to work additional hours where reasonably necessary for project deadlines, client requirements or business operations, subject to applicable law.

6. JOB RESPONSIBILITIES

The Employee shall:

- perform assigned responsibilities;
- meet reasonable deadlines;
- maintain professional standards;
- maintain confidentiality;
- protect Company property;
- protect client information;
- follow security procedures;
- comply with Company policies;
- maintain accurate work records;
- cooperate with team members;
- communicate professionally with clients;
- report problems promptly; and
- act in the Company's legitimate business interests.

The Company may reasonably modify responsibilities according to business requirements and the Employee's role.

7. PROBATION

Where applicable, the Employee shall remain on probation for the period specified in the appointment letter.

During probation, the Company may evaluate:

- work quality;
- technical skills;

- productivity;
- attendance;
- communication;
- discipline;
- teamwork;
- learning ability;
- reliability; and
- overall suitability.

Confirmation of employment shall be communicated by the Company in accordance with its applicable policy.

8. COMPANY POLICIES

The Employee agrees to comply with all applicable Company policies, including:

- HR policies;
- attendance policy;
- leave policy;
- cybersecurity policy;
- information-security policy;
- data-protection policy;
- acceptable-use policy;
- remote-work policy;
- social-media policy;
- anti-harassment policy;
- code of conduct;
- client communication policy;
- intellectual-property policy; and

- any other reasonable policy communicated by the Company.
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9. CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

“Confidential Information” includes all non-public information belonging to the Company or its clients, including:

Business Information

- business plans;
- business strategies;
- pricing;
- quotations;
- proposals;
- financial information;
- sales information;
- marketing strategies;
- customer information;
- supplier information;
- vendor information;
- employee information;
- contracts;
- internal procedures;
- operational information;
- future business plans;
- business opportunities; and
- management information.

Technical Information

- source code;

- software;
 - applications;
 - websites;
 - databases;
 - APIs;
 - API keys;
 - passwords;
 - access credentials;
 - cloud infrastructure;
 - server information;
 - system architecture;
 - technical designs;
 - algorithms;
 - scripts;
 - automation;
 - DevOps configuration;
 - cybersecurity information;
 - AI systems;
 - AI prompts;
 - AI workflows;
 - datasets;
 - technical documentation;
 - proprietary tools;
 - development processes; and
 - unreleased products.
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10. CLIENT CONFIDENTIALITY

The Employee may receive confidential information belonging to Company clients.

The Employee shall protect:

- client information;
- client contact details;
- client requirements;
- client source code;
- client databases;
- client credentials;
- client business information;
- client financial information;
- client customer information;
- client marketing information;
- client contracts;
- client proposals;
- client software;
- client applications;
- client intellectual property; and
- other non-public client information.

The Employee shall not disclose or misuse Client Confidential Information.

11. CONFIDENTIALITY OBLIGATION

The Employee shall:

- keep Confidential Information secret;
- use Confidential Information only for authorised Company work;
- prevent unauthorised access;

- not disclose Confidential Information to third parties;
 - not copy confidential materials unnecessarily;
 - not sell confidential information;
 - not publish confidential information;
 - not use Company information for personal benefit; and
 - immediately report suspected disclosure or misuse.
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12. SOURCE CODE AND PROJECT SECURITY

The Employee shall strictly protect Company and client project resources.

The Employee shall not:

- copy source code to personal repositories;
- upload Company code to personal GitHub/GitLab/Bitbucket;
- share passwords;
- share OTPs;
- share API keys;
- share access tokens;
- share database credentials;
- copy databases;
- download confidential project data for personal use;
- transfer project files to unauthorised devices;
- upload Company files to personal cloud storage;
- bypass access controls;
- access systems outside assigned permissions;
- modify production systems without authorisation;
- delete project data without permission;
- install unauthorised software;

- disclose vulnerabilities to unauthorised persons; or
 - intentionally damage Company infrastructure.
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13. ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND EXTERNAL TOOLS

The Employee shall not upload Company or client Confidential Information to external AI platforms or other third-party services without Company authorisation.

This includes:

- source code;
- credentials;
- databases;
- client information;
- personal data;
- confidential documents;
- proprietary algorithms;
- internal business information;
- unpublished project information; and
- trade secrets.

The Employee shall follow the Company's AI usage and information-security policies.

14. DATA PROTECTION

The Employee shall process personal information only for authorised business purposes and in accordance with applicable law and Company policies.

The Employee shall take reasonable steps to prevent:

- unauthorised access;
- disclosure;
- loss;
- alteration;

- destruction;
- misuse; or
- unauthorised transfer

of personal or confidential information.

The Company may process Employee personal data for legitimate employment, payroll, HR, security, compliance and administrative purposes in accordance with applicable law.

15. SECURITY INCIDENT REPORTING

The Employee shall immediately report suspected:

- data breaches;
- password leaks;
- phishing;
- malware;
- unauthorised access;
- lost devices;
- source-code exposure;
- client-data exposure;
- credential compromise;
- accidental disclosure;
- security vulnerabilities; or
- other security incidents.

The Employee shall cooperate with the Company's investigation and containment process.

16. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

16.1 Subject to applicable law, intellectual property created by the Employee in the course of employment or specifically for Company work shall belong to the Company to the extent legally permissible.

This may include:

- source code;
- software;
- applications;
- websites;
- designs;
- UI/UX;
- graphics;
- videos;
- content;
- documentation;
- databases;
- scripts;
- automation;
- algorithms;
- technical solutions;
- inventions;
- improvements;
- processes;
- research;
- reports;
- marketing materials;
- AI workflows; and
- other work product.

16.2 The Employee agrees to execute reasonable documents required to record or protect the Company's intellectual-property rights.

16.3 The Employee shall not sell, license, publish, distribute or commercially exploit Company-owned work without written authorisation.

17. PRE-EXISTING INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

17.1 Intellectual property independently created by the Employee before employment shall remain the Employee's property, provided it was not created using Company resources or Confidential Information.

17.2 The Employee shall disclose relevant pre-existing intellectual property before incorporating it into Company projects.

17.3 The Employee shall not incorporate third-party or pre-existing material into Company work in a manner that creates an undisclosed legal or licensing obligation.

18. OPEN-SOURCE SOFTWARE

The Employee shall not introduce open-source software into Company or client projects where the applicable licence could create material obligations for the Company without obtaining appropriate approval.

The Employee shall comply with Company software-licensing policies.

19. COMPANY DEVICES AND PROPERTY

Company property may include:

- laptops;
- desktops;
- mobile phones;
- ID cards;
- access cards;
- storage devices;
- software licences;
- documents;

- project files;
- cloud accounts;
- credentials;
- tools;
- equipment; and
- other Company assets.

Company property shall be used only for authorised purposes.

20. RETURN OF COMPANY PROPERTY

Upon resignation, termination or request by the Company, the Employee shall promptly return Company property.

The Employee shall not retain:

- Company documents;
 - source code;
 - credentials;
 - project files;
 - client data;
 - confidential information;
 - devices;
 - storage media; or
 - unauthorised copies.
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21. PERSONAL DEVICES

If the Employee is authorised to use a personal device for Company work, the Employee shall maintain appropriate security.

The Employee shall not knowingly allow unauthorised persons to access Company information.

Upon separation, the Employee shall remove/return Company information in accordance with Company procedures and applicable law.

22. CLIENT COMMUNICATION

The Employee shall communicate with clients professionally and only within the authority assigned to the Employee.

The Employee shall not independently:

- change contractual terms;
- provide unauthorised discounts;
- promise unauthorised delivery dates;
- change project scope;
- collect payments;
- disclose internal information;
- make legal commitments; or
- bind the Company

without appropriate authorisation.

23. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

The Employee shall disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest that may affect the Employee's duties.

The Employee shall not use Company resources, information, clients or opportunities for personal commercial benefit.

24. OUTSIDE EMPLOYMENT / BUSINESS

During employment, the Employee shall not undertake outside employment, consulting or business activities that:

- conflict with Company duties;

- interfere with work;
- use Company resources;
- use Company Confidential Information;
- compete unfairly with the Company; or
- create a material conflict of interest,

without prior written approval where required by Company policy.

25. CLIENT NON-SOLICITATION

During employment and, to the extent permitted by applicable law, for a reasonable period following separation, the Employee shall not use Company Confidential Information to solicit or divert clients with whom the Employee had material business dealings through the Company for the purpose of obtaining business for the Employee or a third party.

This clause is intended to protect legitimate confidential business relationships and shall apply only to the extent permitted by Indian law.

26. EMPLOYEE / TEAM NON-SOLICITATION

The Employee shall not use Company Confidential Information to improperly solicit or induce Company employees to leave the Company for the purpose of benefiting a competing business.

This provision shall operate only to the extent permitted by applicable law.

27. POST-EMPLOYMENT COMPETITION

Nothing in this Agreement shall be interpreted as unlawfully preventing the Employee from earning a livelihood, obtaining employment or carrying on a lawful profession or business after leaving the Company.

However, the Employee shall not:

- use Company trade secrets;
- use Confidential Information;
- copy Company source code;

- misuse client information;
- misuse Company intellectual property;
- use Company credentials;
- take Company databases;
- disclose proprietary business strategies; or
- unfairly exploit protected Company information.

The Company's protection is intended to apply to its legitimate confidential and intellectual-property interests and not to unlawfully restrict the Employee's lawful profession.

28. CONFIDENTIALITY AFTER EMPLOYMENT

Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends.

Trade secrets and information that remain legally protected shall continue to be protected for as long as required by applicable law.

Other Confidential Information shall remain protected for the period reasonably necessary to protect the Company's legitimate interests, subject to applicable law.

29. WORK PRODUCT AFTER EMPLOYMENT

The Employee shall not represent Company-owned work as personal work or use Company-owned source code, confidential project materials or client materials for unauthorised purposes after employment.

The Employee shall not publish confidential Company project information as part of a portfolio without appropriate written permission.

30. NOTICE PERIOD

30.1 The Employee's notice period shall be the period specified in the Employee's appointment letter and applicable Company policy.

Notice Period: _____ days / months

30.2 During the notice period, the Employee shall:

- continue assigned duties;
- maintain performance;
- complete pending work;
- document work;
- transfer knowledge;
- complete project handover;
- return Company property; and
- cooperate with transition activities.

30.3 The Company may waive or modify the notice period where permitted by applicable law and Company policy.

31. RESIGNATION

The Employee may resign by providing the applicable notice specified in the appointment letter.

The resignation shall be processed according to Company HR procedures.

The Company may require proper handover before final separation, subject to applicable law.

32. TERMINATION BY COMPANY

Subject to applicable law and the terms of the appointment letter, the Company may terminate employment for legitimate reasons including:

- serious misconduct;
- breach of confidentiality;
- security violations;
- fraud;
- dishonesty;
- unauthorised access;
- misuse of Company property;
- serious policy violations;

- persistent poor performance;
- repeated unauthorised absence;
- harassment;
- conflict of interest;
- violation of law;
- material breach of employment obligations;
- business restructuring;
- redundancy;
- project closure;
- loss of business; or
- other lawful grounds.

Where applicable, termination shall be conducted in accordance with the appointment letter, Company policy and applicable Indian law.

33. IMMEDIATE SECURITY SUSPENSION

Where the Company reasonably believes that continued system access could create a security, confidentiality or data-protection risk, the Company may immediately suspend or restrict the Employee's access to:

- email;
- Git repositories;
- cloud systems;
- databases;
- client systems;
- project management tools;
- internal applications; or
- other Company systems,

subject to applicable law and Company procedures.

Such access restriction does not by itself determine the final employment status.

34. FINAL HANDOVER

Before separation, the Employee shall reasonably assist with:

- project handover;
 - documentation;
 - transfer of credentials through authorised processes;
 - knowledge transfer;
 - client transition;
 - return of Company property;
 - transfer of work files; and
 - closure of assigned responsibilities.
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35. EMPLOYEE RECORDS

The Company may maintain employment records including:

- employee details;
- attendance;
- payroll information;
- performance records;
- training records;
- disciplinary records where applicable;
- project records;
- access records; and
- other employment-related records.

Such records shall be handled in accordance with applicable law and Company policy.

36. ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATION

The Employee agrees that Company communications may be provided electronically through:

- Company email;
- HR portal;
- employee dashboard;
- authorised messaging systems; and
- other approved communication channels.

The Employee is responsible for regularly checking authorised Company communication channels.

37. ELECTRONIC ACCEPTANCE

By clicking **“I Agree & Accept”** on the Company's HR portal, the Employee confirms acceptance of this Agreement.

The Company may record:

- employee name;
- employee ID;
- registered email;
- date and time of acceptance;
- IP address;
- device/browser information;
- agreement version;
- acceptance status; and
- other reasonable audit information

for maintaining an electronic record of acceptance, subject to applicable law.

38. EMPLOYEE DECLARATION

By accepting this Agreement, I confirm that:

- I have read the Agreement;
- I understand my employment responsibilities;
- I understand my salary and employment terms are governed by my appointment letter;
- I will protect Company Confidential Information;
- I will protect client information;
- I will protect source code;
- I will follow cybersecurity requirements;
- I will protect Company intellectual property;
- I will comply with Company policies;
- I will maintain professional conduct;
- I will comply with the applicable notice period;
- I will return Company property when required;
- I will complete proper handover upon separation;
- I will not misuse Company information after leaving;
- I understand that lawful post-employment restrictions cannot override applicable Indian law; and
- I agree to the terms of this Agreement.

39. ELECTRONIC ACCEPTANCE

☐ **I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THE COMPLETE AGREEMENT.**

☐ **I AGREE TO THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE META MINDS PVT. LTD. EMPLOYEE AGREEMENT.**

☐ **I CONFIRM THAT THE INFORMATION PROVIDED BY ME IS TRUE AND CORRECT.**

[I AGREE & ACCEPT]

40. SYSTEM-GENERATED ACCEPTANCE RECORD

Employee Name: [System Generated]

Employee ID: [System Generated]

Designation: [System Generated]

Department: [System Generated]

Agreement Version: [System Generated]

Date & Time of Acceptance: [System Generated]

IP Address: [System Generated]

Device/Browser: [System Generated]

Acceptance Status: ACCEPTED

Agreement ID: [System Generated]

41. GOVERNING LAW

This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of India.

Nothing in this Agreement shall limit any mandatory rights or protections available to the Employee under applicable law.

42. SEVERABILITY

If any provision of this Agreement is found to be invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue to operate to the extent permitted by law.

Any provision found to be overbroad shall be interpreted to the maximum extent legally permissible.

43. ENTIRE AGREEMENT

This Agreement shall be read together with the Employee's appointment letter and applicable Company policies.

Where a specific employment term in the appointment letter conflicts with a general provision of this Agreement, the specific written employment term shall apply to that matter, subject to applicable law.

META MINDS PVT. LTD.

HR / Administration

Agreement Version: [VERSION]

Effective Date: [DATE]

Last Updated: [DATE]